

two years right, they will never make it. That is where the selectors need to focus. I am not using the word board because in many cases boards are advised by headhunters. And these headhunters are really the selectors. The rest of the hiring is just a process.

Second, most companies rely on psychometrics because it can flag something, and then you have to assess what the selected person can tackle in the first two years. His track record will then convince the selectors he can learn to manage the first two years.

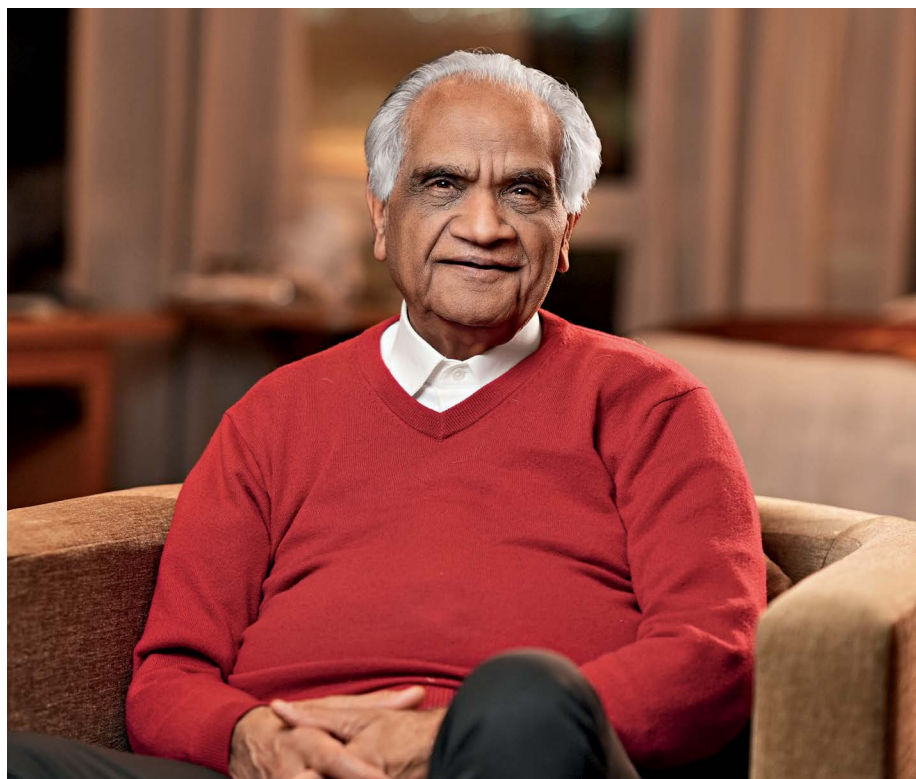
Even if he does not have this skill, he can hire people to get the task done. There is no way to forecast what will be needed in 10 years.

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You have been a consultant to many powerful global CEOs and companies.

What is it that makes you so unique that one of the business magazines has called you, 'the most influential advisor living in the world'?

I fail too. The old rule exists. You have value when you are wanted. You don't go to the CEO and say I am the solution to your problem. You go to a CEO who has a problem, and you must say, "Maybe



I can help, maybe I cannot. But I should do everything to deliver." Recently, I solved a problem for a Chinese company on whose board I used to sit. It had a \$3 billion business but was making huge losses. It took me about nine months to understand the problem. Now, it has a one billion Renminbi profit.

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You have written about 10 industries in the US which will get obliterated. Which do you think are the main sectors in India that could be affected by the 90%

model of China?

Every industry. Bar none. There is the 3:1 ratio. You buy something for three dollars in India that you can buy for one dollar in China. It is a fact.

Therefore, so long as the above continues, there is no way that India can compete with China. What do we export to China? Very little: processed foods, raw materials and things of that kind. That is not industrialisation. That is reduction of industrialisation.

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Can you tell me a little bit about your early life and family?

In the 1920s, my father and uncle got together to start a cloth business. My father could write a bit, but my uncle was illiterate. They used to buy, for example, 20 yards of cloth from the market and make shirts for the villagers. They also used to sell sarees.

In 1947, during the Partition riots, their shop got burnt. My brother started a shoe shop, and it did well. When I was in school, my teachers came and told my father that this kid is bright and needs to go to an engineering college. I applied and I was admitted within 24 hours. That is how I began. **BT**